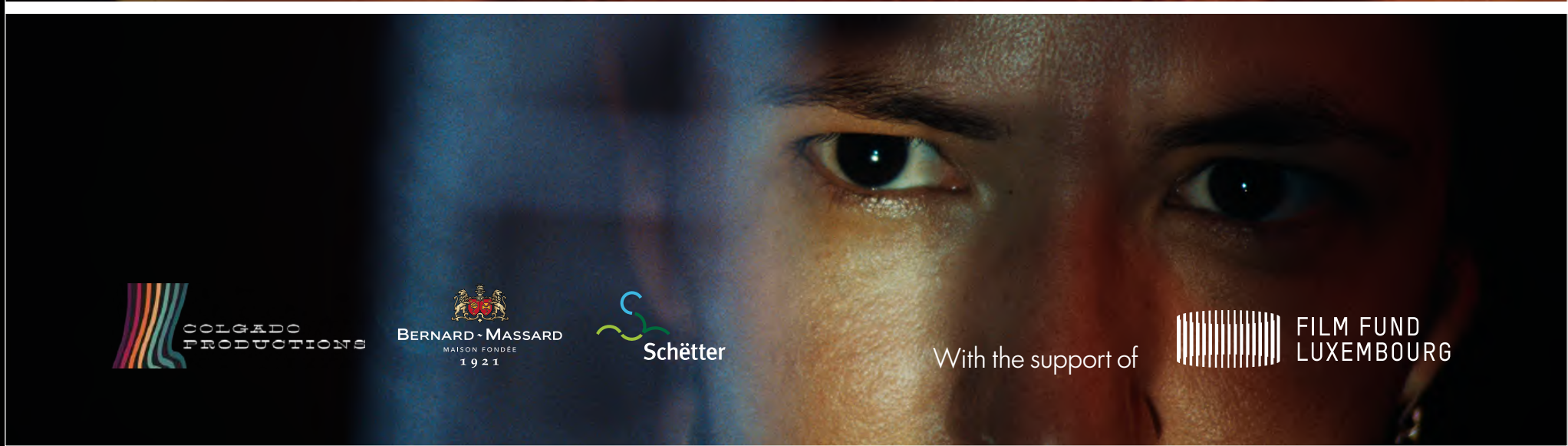




ORLÈNE DABADIE
ALESSIA RASCHELLA



A FILM BY
ALEXIS VANDEWEERD
& **JULES WAX**



With the support of



Colgado Productions
present

in co-production with
L'Image Cristal

with the support of
Film Fund Luxembourg

Cruise Me, Cruise Me Babe

instagram **@cruiseme_babe**

Written and directed by
Alexis Vandeweerd & Jules Wax

SYNOPSIS

Inspired by Magritte's paintings, this film tells the story of an insomniac photographer, MAXY, who, during a late-night phone conversation with a mysterious girl named BLISS, recalls witnessing a surreal encounter: the soul of a man dressed in a tuxedo, floating in the sky, being guided through Luxembourg's city streets by an angel.

DURATION 16 min

TECHNIQUE

Live action short fiction film

ORIGINAL SOUNDTRACK

Yliana Paolini (The Night FM)

DISTRIBUTION

Cinestrib (France)
Hors du bocal (Belgique)

*Don't worry.
Our connection is stronger than that*

DIRECTOR'S NOTE

Cruise me, cruise me Babe is a cinematic reverie on the frontiers of the visible and the unconscious. A floating space between the silent poetry of Magritte and the troubled tension of David Lynch. The film is positioned as a work on the borderline between narrative and experimental cinema, aimed at audiences sensitive to singular writing and daring artistic approaches.

We didn't start with what we wanted to show, but with what we wanted people to feel

Alexis Vandeweerd
& Jules Wax

THE POWER OF SENSATION

Rather than explicit explanations, the film emphasizes the power of sensation and atmosphere. Maxy's apartment is distinctly lit by a constant red lighting such as those from photographic darkrooms. This aesthetic is mirrored in the bar sequences, which feature surreal tones of dark red and blue to deepen the connection with the apartment's atmosphere. The goal is to invoke Magritte's artistic methods, like combining contrasting elements.

FACES, IMAGES

Aside from giving voice to Luxembourg's cinematic landscape and its technicians, it is also about showing the peculiarities of its streets, the history of some of city center architecture, and the great casemates fortifications leading to the poetic downtown of the Grund, a poetic interworld, a passage to the mysterious.

Beyond the surreal and atmospheric experience we aim to create, this project is also a reflection on the loved ones we've lost — and the images we hold onto and create to keep them alive, even when they bring physical pain, like the ache of sleepless nights.



Funny how secrets travel

A VISUAL LANGUAGE

Visually, key imagery such as the angel and the soul are achieved through green-screen techniques, allowing precise insertion of characters into an ethereal, sky-based backdrop. Similarly, the church scenes replicate Magritte's iconic painting, *The Empire of Light*, matching simultaneous night and day lighting techniques within a single frame. Character portrayals lean heavily on symbolic visuals: BLISS is presented in the first half of the film through a close-up of her lips with deeply colored red lipstick, emphasizing her enigmatic presence. The male character in the sky embodies Magritte's recurrent motif: dressed in a suit, tie, bowler hat, and carrying a cane. The film's sound design relies on deep, resonating bass tones to create an eerie atmosphere all along the movie to amplify the mystical aspect of the story.

THE SCORE: ANOTHER CHARACTER IN THE FILM

When I first read the script, I knew that I could write an original score for it. The film deeply resonated with the direction of my own music and artistic practice; the atmosphere and the nuances resonated with me right away, and it immediately reminded me of filmmakers who I deeply admire, like David Lynch and Denis Villeneuve. Many parts of the film are filled with that nuance, moments where nothing is said, and silence becomes part of the score, allowing the sound and music to dance together with the image and the environment.

The main theme, *Cruise Me Babe*, was directly inspired by the “tempo as a driving character.” When Jules and Alexis gave me the lyrics, I started thinking about tempo and the kind of voice that could perform it: Chantal Maya was the choice for *Cruise Me Babe*, and we approached it almost like a downtempo, trip-hop piece, with her soft and laid-back vocals. *Cruise Me Babe* was the pulse of the bar scene, almost like it was guiding the walking and breathing of the characters. From there, I felt like music and image should dance together with one another, almost choreographically, so I wanted the textures and rhythm to interact with what was happening on the screen. Because of that, my first choices were drones, pads, and sustained sounds, as I wanted the music to reinforce the eerie feeling that was already present rather than competing with it. So ultimately, I approached the music and sound as another part and character in the film, always moving with the story.



Cruise Me, Cruise Me Babe

Yliana Paolini | The Night FM

TECHNICAL & ARTISTIC SPECIFICATIONS

DURATION 16 min	1st ASSISTANT DIRECTOR Raphaël Sossa
TECHNIQUE Live action short fiction film	DIRECTOR OF PHOTOGRAPHY Colin Donner
ORIGINAL SOUNDTRACK Yliana Paolini (The Night FM)	EDITOR Felix Sorger
DISTRIBUTION Cinestrib (France & International)	ASPECT RATIO 1,78:1



DIRECTION Alexis Vandeweerd & Jules Wax	SET DECORATION Iman Moussamih
SCRIPT Alexis Vandeweerd & Jules Wax	POST-PRODUCTION Soundtastic Studio L'imagerie Studio
CAST MAXY Orlène Dabadie BLISS Alessia Raschella	SOUND Dolby 5.1
PRODUCERS Aymeric Bolé Alexis Vandeweerd Jules Wax	PARTNERS FilmFund Luxembourg Schuttrange Commune Bernard Massard House of Japan Eye-Lite Mesa Verde

Cruise Me, Cruise Me Babe

*An unusual and experimental project
that succeeds in creating an atmosphere;
The Commission wishes to give the applicant
the opportunity to carry out
this visually promising project.*

Film Fund Luxembourg

**SAIL WITH ME.
BABY.
FOLLOW THE ANGELS.
THEY GUIDE SOULS
INTO THE BAR.**

*I find the project interesting, and it really appeals
to my sensibilities in terms of experimental cinema,
photography, and art.*

Yann Tonar, Manufactura Prod.

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